

SIMATS ENGINEERING

ASSESSMENT TOOL 3

COURSE NAME: CSA16 COURSE CODE: Data Warehousing and Data Mining

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO5: Apply association rule mining techniques to discover interesting relationships and patterns within large datasets

Assessment Tool Weightage: 30%

QUESTIONS: 05

Total Marks:50

Annexure A

MOCK INTERVIEW

Criteria	Technical Knowledge (2.5)	Problem Solving (2.5)	Analytical Thinking (1.5)	Communication(1.5)	Confidence (1)	Response to Questions(1)	Total(10)
Weightage	25%	25%	15%	15%	10%	10%	100%
Q1							
Q2							

Code of Conduct:

IG Madhulatha(192311295)(Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment.

I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the student:

G Madhulatha

RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION:

Criteria	Weightage	Level 4 (Exemplary)	Level 3 (Proficient)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 1 (Beginning)
Technical Knowledge	25	Demonstrates strong and accurate subject knowledge with in-depth understanding	Shows good knowledge with minor gaps	Basic knowledge with noticeable errors	Lacks fundamental technical knowledge
Problem Solving	25	Solves problems logically and applies concepts effectively in real scenarios	Applies concepts with moderate accuracy	Limited problem-solving ability; requires guidance	Unable to solve or apply concepts
Analytical Thinking	15	Analyzes questions critically and provides well-structured, logical answers	Provides reasonable analysis with some structure	Superficial or partially structured responses	No analytical thinking demonstrated
Communication	15	Communicates clearly, confidently, and professionally with proper terminology	Communicates well with minor hesitation	Communication lacks clarity or confidence	Unable to communicate effectively
Confidence	15	Displays high confidence, positive attitude, and professional behavior throughout	Shows good confidence with minor issues	Low confidence; inconsistent behavior	Lacks confidence and professionalism
Response to Questions	10	Responds accurately, promptly, and elaborates with relevant examples	Responds correctly but with limited depth	Partial responses; needs prompting	Unable to respond appropriately

Annexure A

Mock Interview – Sample Questions (5 Questions)

(Each question aligned with BL3–BL4, 0.75 Marks each)

Q1. Dataset: Retail Transactions

TID	Items
T1	Milk, Bread
T2	Milk, Butter
T3	Bread, Butter
T4	Milk, Bread, Butter
T5	Milk, Eggs

Question:

Based on the dataset, explain how association rule mining can improve sales in a retail store. Provide a practical example. (BL3 – 0.75 Marks)

Q2. Dataset: Transaction Data

TID	Items
T1	A, B
T2	B, C
T3	A, C
T4	A, B, C
T5	B, C

Question:

Using this dataset, explain the differences between Apriori and FP-Growth algorithms and when each should be used. (BL4 – 0.75 Marks)

Q3. Dataset: Transaction Data

TID	Items
T1	A, B
T2	A
T3	B
T4	A, B
T5	A

Question:

Explain support and confidence using the dataset and describe their importance in association rule mining. (BL3 – 0.75 Marks)

Q4 . Dataset: Multilevel Data

TID	Items
T1	Electronics, Mobile
T2	Electronics, Laptop
T3	Electronics, Mobile
T4	Electronics, Mobile
T5	Electronics, Laptop

Question:

Explain multilevel association rules using the dataset and compare them with multidimensional rules. (BL4 – 0.75 Marks)

Q5. Dataset: Large Transaction Sample

TID	Items
T1	A, B, C
T2	A, B
T3	B, C
T4	A, C
T5	A, B, C

Question:

Discuss challenges in mining large datasets using the given sample and explain how scalable methods address these issues. (BL4 – 0.75 Marks)

Q1. Retail Transactions

Association rule mining finds relationships between products that customers frequently purchase together.

*From the given data, **Milk and Bread** occur together in T1 and T4. Therefore, the store can identify a relationship between these products.*

Practical example:

*The store can place **Bread near Milk** or offer a discount such as “**Buy Milk and get Bread at a reduced price.**” This encourages customers to purchase both products and can increase overall sales.*

Q2. Transaction Data

Difference between Apriori and FP-Growth

Apriori:

- Generates candidate itemsets level by level.
- Requires multiple scans of the database.
- Uses the minimum support to eliminate infrequent itemsets.
- Simple and easy to understand.
- Suitable for **small datasets**.

FP-Growth:

- Uses an **FP-tree** to store transaction information.
- Does not generate large numbers of candidate itemsets.
- Requires fewer database scans.
- Generally faster than Apriori for large datasets.
- Suitable for **large datasets**.

Using the given dataset

The frequent relationships such as **B and C** can be discovered by both algorithms.

For example, B and C occur together in:

T2, T4 and T5

Support:

$$3/5 \times 100 = 60\%$$

Therefore, if the minimum support is 60%, **{B, C} is a frequent itemset**.

Conclusion

Use **Apriori** when the dataset is small and simplicity is important. Use **FP-Growth** when the dataset is large and faster frequent-itemset mining is required.

Q1. Retail Transactions

Answer:

Association rule mining finds relationships between products that are frequently purchased together.

From the given dataset, Milk and Bread occur together in T1 and T4.

- Milk occurs in T1, T2, T4 and T5.
- Bread occurs in T1, T3 and T4.
- Milk and Bread occur together in T1 and T4.

Therefore, the store can identify a relationship between Milk and Bread.

Practical example:

The store can place Bread near Milk or provide an offer such as “Buy Milk and get Bread at a reduced price.”

This encourages customers to purchase both products and can increase overall sales.

Short interview answer:

Association rule mining identifies products that customers frequently buy together. Here, Milk and Bread occur together, so the store can place them nearby or offer a combo discount to increase sales.

Q2. Transaction Data

Difference between Apriori and FP-Growth

Apriori	FP-Growth
Generates candidate itemsets level by level.	Uses an FP-tree to represent transactions.
Requires multiple database scans.	Requires fewer database scans.
Generates candidate itemsets.	Does not generate large numbers of candidate itemsets.
Simple and easy to understand.	More efficient for large datasets.
Suitable for small datasets.	Suitable for large datasets.

Using the given dataset

The itemset {B, C} occurs together in:

- T2 → B, C
- T4 → A, B, C
- T5 → B, C

Therefore:

$$\text{Support}(\{B, C\}) = 3/5 \times 100 = 60\%$$

So, if the minimum support is 60%, {B,C} is a frequent itemset.

Conclusion

Apriori is preferred for small datasets because it is simple and easy to understand. FP-Growth is preferred for large datasets because it is generally faster and avoids generating many candidate itemsets.

Q3. Support and Confidence

Given Dataset

TID	Items
T1	A, B
T2	A
T3	B
T4	A, B
T5	A

1. Support

Support tells us how frequently an itemset occurs in the entire transaction database.

For {A,B}:

{A,B} occurs in T1 and T4.

Therefore:

$$\text{Support}(A,B) = 2/5 \times 100 = 40\%$$

2. Confidence

Confidence tells us how often B is purchased when A is purchased.

A occurs in:

- T1
- T2
- T4
- T5

So A occurs 4 times.

A and B occur together 2 times.

Therefore:

$$\text{Confidence}(A \rightarrow B) = \text{Support}(A,B) / \text{Support}(A)$$

$$= 2/4 \times 100$$

$$= 50\%$$

Importance

- Support identifies frequently occurring itemsets.
- Confidence measures the strength of an association rule.
- They help retailers identify useful product relationships.

Short interview answer:

Support tells how frequently an itemset occurs, while confidence tells how reliably one item is associated with another. In this dataset, support of {A,B} is 40%, and confidence of $A \rightarrow B$ is 50%.

Q4. Multilevel Association Rules

Given Dataset

TID	Items
T1	Electronics, Mobile
T2	Electronics, Laptop
T3	Electronics, Mobile
T4	Electronics, Mobile
T5	Electronics, Laptop

Multilevel Association Rules

Multilevel association rules discover relationships at different levels of abstraction in a concept hierarchy.

For example:

Electronics $\rightarrow$ Mobile

Here, Electronics is a higher-level category and Mobile is a more specific product category.

From the dataset:

- Electronics occurs in all 5 transactions.
- Mobile occurs in T1, T3 and T4.
- Laptop occurs in T2 and T5.

Therefore, a rule such as:

Electronics $\rightarrow$ Mobile

can be used to identify relationships between a general product category and a specific product.

Multilevel vs Multidimensional

Multilevel Association Rules	Multidimensional Association Rules
Work at different levels of a concept hierarchy.	Use multiple attributes/dimensions.
Example: Electronics → Mobile.	Example: Age = Young → Buys Mobile.
Focus on different levels of detail.	Focus on relationships among different attributes.
Useful for category-level and product-level analysis.	Useful for customer/profile-based analysis.

Short interview answer:

Multilevel association rules discover relationships at different levels of a hierarchy, such as Electronics → Mobile. Multidimensional rules use different attributes such as age, income, product and location.

Q5. Large Transaction Dataset

Given Dataset

TID	Items
T1	A, B, C
T2	A, B
T3	B, C
T4	A, C
T5	A, B, C

Challenges in Mining Large Datasets

Mining large datasets can create several problems:

- Large number of transactions
Processing millions of transactions requires more time.
- Large number of candidate itemsets
Algorithms such as Apriori can generate many candidate combinations.
- High memory usage
Storing and processing large datasets requires more memory.
- Multiple database scans
Repeatedly scanning a large database increases processing time.

How scalable methods solve these problems

FP-Growth can be used because it stores transactions in an FP-tree and avoids generating a large number of candidate itemsets.

Other scalable approaches can use:

- Data partitioning
- Parallel processing
- Distributed computing
- Efficient data structures
- Reduced database scans

Example from the dataset

The itemset {A,B,C} occurs in:

- T1
- T5

Therefore:

$\text{Support}(\{A,B,C\}) = 2/5 \times 100 = 40\%$

If the minimum support is 40%, {A,B,C} is a frequent itemset.

Conclusion

Large datasets create problems such as high computation time, memory requirements and many candidate itemsets. Scalable algorithms such as FP-Growth, along with parallel and distributed processing, can reduce these problems and make frequent-itemset mining faster.